



"Octocama" which will allow the wearer to literally blend in with his surroundings. The player will also be able to interrogate guards for information and supplies. With the motto of nowhere to hide, the game throws you in the middle of several battlefields, and stealth and combat are equally important. Apart from Octocama, Snake will employ a monocular device called Solid Eye which acts as binoculars and image intensifiers, and a drum to complement the cardboard box disguise. Snake will also partner with a robot called the Metal Gear Mk. II, which will stand in for the CODEC system of old and allow communication between game characters. Mk. II will also offer a degree of anti-personnel combat via your ability to remotely control it and engage enemies using an electric shock. *Metal Gear Solid 4* will take place in five locations around the world, three of which have been revealed to be: the Middle East, South America, and somewhere in Eastern Europe. Four new bosses were also recently introduced: Screaming Mantis, Laughing Octopus, Raging Raven, and Crying Wolf, of The Beauty and the Beast Unit—all four women suffering from post-traumatic stress.

Only thing more badass than Snake is a geriatric Snake. We're serious!

Spore

TBA

Life simulation

PC

An entire magazine could be devoted to talking the scope and feature of *Spore*—perhaps the most ambitious game to come out in this decade, and certainly the most ambitious title from Sim superhero Will Wright. The game can best be described by its once-code-name: Sim Everything. In *Spore*, the player guides a multicellular organism to sentience and ultimately to space travel and world conquest! Each of the game's various phases offers a different type of gameplay: for example, as a simple protean microbe, you are required to move in a 2D environment, dealing with fluid dynamics, being eaten, and weaker microbes—this particular phase is akin to *Pac-Man*. Later, you can control tribes which have evolved from the same multicellular organism in a gameplay experience similar to an RTS game, and finally you can take to space, conquer different planets by



force or diplomacy, destroy worlds, create worlds, and so on...

What makes the game truly unique is that it calls itself a Massively Multiplayer Single Player Game. Everything that the player creates (and the game allows you to create everything—from the creatures, to its houses, to the worlds) is shared with other players playing *Spore*, but within a single-player environment. Thus, you may find that your world is populated by creatures created by others, or you might be offered to opportunity to buy items made by others, or to visit planets created or populated by others. For example, if there is a lack of predators in your world, the game will automatically download creatures from another player into your world to balance out the ecosystem. The final galaxy phase of the game is claimed to offer over half a million different stars, each one having its own planets! The game will never really end (much like Will Wright's other Sim titles) and the Space Phase continues for as long as the player wishes.

This is blasphemy! This is madness!

Madness...? THIS... IS... SPORE-TA!

Far Cry 2

Q2 2008

First-person shooter

PC

Ubisoft is handling the sequel to the hit *Far Cry* games, now that Crytek sold the rights to the French studio. This time, the game will not feature any supernatural or sci-fi elements, and will further veer from the first part by offering not one, but 12 different mercenaries to play as. Set in Africa, the game will be entirely open-ended and non-linear. After you choose from one of the 12 mercenaries, the remaining will be encountered in the game as friends. The game will feature terrain ranging from savanna to jungle and the weather will depend upon how well you do in the game: sunny skies when everything is going well for you will give way to thunder and lightning when you are in trouble. Various factions and vehicles will be featured, and the gameplay area will be around 50 square km.

Will it be a far cry from its sequel? Ha ha, punny...



Wii Fit

Early 2008

Simulation, exergaming

Wii

The Wii series of games have enjoyed immense popularity the world over—both *Wii Sports* and *Wii Play* have been well-received. Hoping to continue the winning formula, Nintendo will introduce *Wii Fit* (called *Wii Fitness* in Europe) sometime next year outside of Japan (Japan release is this December). *Wii Fit*, just like the other titles in the series, will integrate Miis into its presentation and gameplay. The game

Singstar

February 2008

Music

PS3

Infamous

TBA 2008

Third person shooter, open-ended

PS3

Killzone 2

TBA 2008

First-person shooter

The Agency

TBA 2008

Massively Multiplayer Online Shooter

PS3

Lost Oddysee

February 2008

RPG

X360

Banjo-Kazooie 3

TBA 2008

Platformer

X360

Harvey Birdman: Attorney at Law

TBA 2008

Visual Novel

Wii PSP PS2

Sonic Riders: Zero Gravity

February 2008

Racing

Wii PS2

Dragon Quest Swords: The Masked Queen and the Tower of Mirrors

TBA 2008

RPG

Wii

Opoona

TBA 2008

RPG

Wii

Endless Ocean

January 2008

Adventure

Wii